

Imli-Khajur Chutney

Tamarind-Date · Sweet-sour-spiced · 6-month freeze stability

Single Batch (~16 cubes — day-of or small top-up)

Ingredient	Amount	Notes
Medjool dates (pitted)	10–12	Blend with water until completely smooth
Tropica concentrated tamarind	3 tbsp	3–4× more concentrated than raw block — do not sub 1:1
Water	1.5 cups	
Salt	1 tsp	
Black salt (kala namak)	½ tsp	
Roasted cumin powder	2 tsp	
Ginger — dry powder	1 tsp	OR: blend 1.5–2 inch fresh knob into dates in step 1
Star anise (ground)	1/16 tsp	Preferred over fennel — same family, more depth. ~4× potent: do not exceed.
Red chili powder	½ tsp	
Cinnamon	¼ tsp	Bridges dates + tamarind
Black pepper	¼ tsp	
Hing (asafoetida)	■ tsp	

Method (single batch or 24 qt pot batch)



S te p	Action
1	Blend pitted dates + water (+ fresh ginger if using) until completely smooth — no chunks
2	Pour date paste into pot. Add Tropica tamarind, stir to dissolve.
3	Add all spices + salts. Stir to combine.
4	Medium heat — stir frequently — 15–20 min until ribbon consistency (coats back of spoon)
5	Taste: equal sweet-sour-spiced. More tamarind if too sweet; pinch salt if flat.
6	Optional: push through mesh strainer for silky texture — removes date fiber pulp.
7	Cool COMPLETELY before portioning. Looks thin hot — thickens as it cools.
8	Pour ~2 tbsp per cube into ice cube trays. Freeze solid (~4 hrs). Bag + label.

Freeze stability: 6 months (high acid pH ~2.5 + natural sugar creates hostile environment for microbes).

Thaw: 1 cube at room temp 20 min, or 30 sec microwave.



3-Month Batch (24 qt Pot — One Cook)

×6 single batch · 2 Vitamix blend runs → combine into 24 qt pot → one cook

Step 1 — Blend (2 Vitamix runs)

Ingredient	Per Vitamix run (×3 batch)	× 2 runs = full 3-month batch
Medjool dates (pitted)	30–36 dates (~600g)	60–72 dates (~1.2 kg)
Water	4.5 cups	9 cups total
Fresh ginger (blend in step 1)	5 tsp grated (~5–6 inch knob)	~200g total

Blend each run until completely smooth. Pour both into the 24 qt pot.

Step 2 — Cook in 24 qt Pot (once combined)

Ingredient	Amount for full batch	Notes
Tropica tamarind	18 tbsp (~1.1 cups)	Stir into combined date paste until dissolved
Salt	2 tbsp	
Black salt (kala namak)	1 tbsp	
Roasted cumin powder	4 tbsp	
Star anise (ground)	■ tsp	Do not exceed — potent
Red chili powder	1 tbsp	
Cinnamon	$\frac{3}{4}$ tsp	
Black pepper	$\frac{3}{4}$ tsp	



Hing	■ tsp	
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24 qt pot note: the pre-cook liquid (~10–12 cups) sits shallow in a 24 qt pot — stir more frequently than normal (every 2–3 min) to prevent hotspots. Medium heat only. Cook 15–20 min until ribbon consistency.

Output	Volume	Cubes	Supply
Full 3-month batch	~2 liters	~96	~3 months at 1/day

Jaggery Variant (Traditional — thinner)

Change	Amount (single)	Amount (×6 batch)
Remove: dates	—	—
Add: jaggery	80–100g	480–600g
Extra water	+½ cup	+3 cups

Jaggery: dissolve directly in water in pot (no blending). Result: thinner, more pourable, slightly higher GI, trace iron/potassium from molasses.

■ Cool COMPLETELY before portioning — hot chutney in ice trays cracks the tray. Tropica concentrate is 3–4× more potent than raw block tamarind — never substitute 1:1.